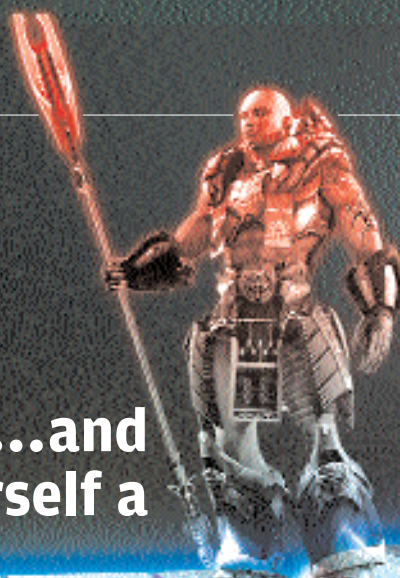




...and
you call yourself a

GAMER?

Not unless your eyes have bled in joy, and your fingers callused under the exuberant toil of playing these gems. PC or console, we call out the greatest titles ever to have graced gaming. Ever!

Ahmed Shaikh

A true gamer doesn't need an introduction to a gaming article. After years of stalking its love across message boards, the true gamer will tear off its beloved's shrink-wrap, throw away its manual, ignore its EULA pleas, download its no-CD crack, skip its cut-scenes, and proceed to have an ultimately-doomed carpal relationship, with veins a-throbbing! Does such a mortal need an intro-

duction? Perish the thought! Suffice to say, we shall reveal games worthy of such delicious hyperbole that even grammar will fail us! Nurse! More exclamation points! Stat!

SONY PLAYSTATION 2

We begin with Sony's answer to organised religion—the PlayStation 2, aka the PS2. The console has sold more than 100 million units worldwide. Not owning one will bring shame to your family. Buy one, play these:

Devil May Cry 3: Dante's Awakening—Special Edition

Who is Dante you ask? He is our very own Rajnikanth as imagined by the Japanese and molded in the image of an overzealous *Amrikaan*. He thus transcends boundaries and culture, and is like a god; except he is the son of a demon, and has to suffer through over-the-top action, an-independent-and-yet-

beautiful-woman-armed-to-the-teeth-with-guns, and one sibling rivalry straight from Bollywood. Much ass-kicking follows, with various firearms and *melée* weapons. *Dante's Awakening* also throws in some wild fighting styles to the mix. As a Gunslinger, for example, you can use two sawed-off shotguns as nunchuks, air-juggle a hellspawn, teleport to the other side of the room, use a downed baddie as a surfboard, and do nasty things to demon biology with oversized swords. The combat unleashed by this game is relentless and requires split-second timing to avoid counterattacks, and to chain deadly combos. This game will destroy your fingers, and its boss battles, your soul. But play it you must.

God Of War

If Quentin Tarantino were a game designer, Kratos would be his Samuel L Jackson, except with blades of chaos chained to his arms; so much more effective than a purple lightsaber

